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Martin's Funerals

Module 4

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF RECEIPT

I hereby acknowledge receipt of the *Martin's Funerals Operations Manual* and confirm that I understand and accept the confidentiality obligations relating to the Martin's Funerals brand, trademarks, trade secrets, copyright, operational know-how, and goodwill, whether currently existing or arising in the future.

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Editions and Copyright

Editions:

1st–2nd Editions: February 1998

3rd Edition: March 2000

4th Edition: November 2000

5th Edition: June 2001

6th Edition: February 2006

7th Edition: May 2007

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All discretionary powers exercised under this Manual shall be applied reasonably, proportionately, and in good faith, and—except where immediate action or objectively necessary is objectively required to prevent serious harm, illegality, or regulatory breach—only after written notice and a reasonable opportunity to remedy, in accordance with section 48 of the Consumer Protection Act, 68 of 2008.

Where technical or legal language is used, it must be interpreted in a manner that is understandable to a reasonable franchisee or consumer, and any ambiguity shall be resolved in favour of fairness, transparency, and consumer protection.

THE MARTIN'S FUNERALS (MF) FILE

Confidential Franchise Operations Manual

Purpose and Importance of the MF File

The Martin's Funerals (MF) File is a **core operational document** and forms the backbone of every funeral arrangement conducted within the franchise.

This file, together with all supporting documentation, **must be securely stored for a minimum period of fifteen (15) years**. After this period, physical documents may be destroyed **only if complete and accurate records have been retained electronically**.

For long-term reference, it is recommended that all historical records be archived digitally using secure storage media.

Confidentiality Requirement

The MF File contains sensitive and confidential information. It must **remain in your possession at all times** and be stored in a **locked and secure location**.

Standardisation Rule

The MF File is a **standardised franchise document** and **may not be altered, amended, or customised** without **written approval from Martin's Funerals Franchising (Pty) Ltd.**

Initial Family Consultation Guidelines

During the first consultation with the family, the following process must be followed:

1. **Explain Required Information**
Clearly explain what documentation and information are required to ensure accurate service delivery and pricing.
2. **Planning Transparency**
Inform the family that most planning and arrangements will be completed **in their presence**. This ensures transparency and alignment with their expectations.
3. **Identification Documents**
Obtain the identity documents of:
 - The deceased, and
 - The family member responsible for making arrangements.
4. **Mortuary Admission First**
Explain that the deceased must first be admitted to your mortuary before final arrangements or pricing can be confirmed. This ensures correct coffin sizing and service requirements.

Completion Rule

Where any question is not applicable, clearly write **"NOT APPLICABLE"** or **"N/A"** in the relevant field.

REGISTRATION OF DEATH

Legal Registration Process

Submit the **DHA-1663 (Medical Certificate of Death / Stillbirth)** to the nearest Department of Home Affairs office. Upon registration, the following documents will be issued:

- **BI-14** – Burial Order
- **BI-20 / BI-5** – Death Certificate

Registration must be completed **within 48 hours of death**. Withholding registration is **illegal**.

Designated Registration Authority

To personally register deaths, you must:

- Register with Home Affairs
- Successfully complete the required examination
- Obtain a **Designation Number**

Handling of Death Certificates

- Provide the family with:
 - The **original Death Certificate**
 - **5–10 certified copies**
- Retain **one certified copy** in the MF File.
- Obtain the family's **signature of receipt** for the original certificate.
- Death certificates may **only be issued to the person who signed the MF File**.

If the original certificate is lost, a duplicate may be requested from Home Affairs on the family's behalf.

TYPES OF GRAVES

Grave Categories

- **Deepened Grave**
Allows two coffins in one grave. Common for spouses or children. Additional costs apply.
- **Broadened Grave**
Required for oversized coffins or caskets. BI-14 must clearly reflect coffin dimensions.
- **Double Grave**
Used for large individuals or family tragedies. Availability must be confirmed with the cemetery.
- **Single Grave**
Standard grave for a standard coffin.
- **Children / Stillborn Graves**
Must be specified—usually located in designated cemetery sections.
- **Existing Grave**
Always physically inspect the grave. Confirm depth and monument status.

Memorial Options

- **Monument / Memorial Graves**
Allow full tombstone installation after a regulated period.
- **Garden / Berm Graves**
Grass areas with headstones permitted after a set time.

SPECIAL REQUESTS AND ARRANGEMENTS

Special family requests may include (but are not limited to):

- Private family entry into church
- Flower transfers to reception venues
- Display photos on coffins
- Wreath placement preferences
- Accessibility requirements
- Religious or cultural rituals

All requests must be clearly recorded in the MF File.

VIEWING OF THE DECEASED

- Record the **date, time, and location** of the viewing.
- Viewings at your facility must occur **before transport to the church or residence**.
- Church viewings require **ministerial approval**.

Viewing is a vital part of the grieving process and must be handled with sensitivity.

PHOTOGRAPHY

- Confirm whether service photographs are required (**never of the deceased**).
- Arrange post-service collection from your office.

METHOD OF PAYMENT

Payment Policy

- **Full payment must be received before the service is conducted.**
- Payment may be made over time **prior** to the service date.

Sales Methods

- **Cash Sale (Pink Book)**
Immediate full payment.
- **Invoice (Blue Book)**
Issued when payment is pending (e.g., loan applications).

REMOVAL OF A DECEASED

Accurate documentation is critical. Record:

- Date and time
- Caller details
- Removal address and directions
- Body description
- Cause of death

Important:

Only **natural deaths** may be removed by your service.

Unnatural deaths are handled exclusively by Government Mortuaries.

Drivers must carry full removal equipment and complete toe-tag identification **on site**, signed by a responsible family member.

Mortuary Admission Procedures

- Complete mortuary records **before storage**
- Verify identification
- Disinfect and mark the deceased discreetly
- Ensure dignity and privacy at all times

Removal from Hospitals and Government Mortuaries

- Use appropriate authority forms (e.g. **S.A.P.-382**)
- Confirm:
 - Case number
 - Autopsy completion
 - Storage fees
 - Removal time

DHA-1663: NOTIFICATION OF DEATH

This form must be obtained **within 1–2 days** of death and verified carefully. Only authorised persons may complete it.

Keep:

- A copy in the MF File
- Original attachments sealed as required

Burial Orders and Cemetery Documentation

- **BI-14** acts as:
 - Transport permit
 - Grave purchase authority
- Must be completed in black ink, in duplicate
- Grave purchase must occur **24–48 hours before the service**

Scheduling and Operational Control

- Maintain a **Weekly Time Schedule**
- Allow **minimum 3-hour intervals** between services
- Prevent double bookings at all costs

FUNERAL INSTRUCTIONS FORM

This form replaces the MF File outside the office and must be issued **one day before the service**.

Colour-coding may be used to improve efficiency.

Ownership and Confidentiality

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